

# Steven Kawuma Match Prep Report

Opponent: Steven Male Kawuma | rating 2164 | FIDE 10000224 | Southampton | no credible Chess.com account found

**Bottom line: Steven Kawuma looks like a dynamic, calculation-ready and comfortable in open or semi-open structures player. This report is based on 174 source PGNs, 144 deduped games, with known dates spanning 2000.10.30 to 2026.02.28. Most recent parsed game: 2026.02.28 Akeya-Price, Robert - Kawuma, Steven Male 0-1.**

| Evidence                | Value                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Source PGNs             | 174                                                                                                      |
| Deduped games used      | 144                                                                                                      |
| Overall score in sample | 80.5/144 (55.9%)                                                                                         |
| White score             | 41.5/74 (56.1%)                                                                                          |
| Black score             | 39/70 (55.7%)                                                                                            |
| Last 10 dated games     | 8.5/10 (85.0%)                                                                                           |
| Since 2025              | 8.5/10 (85.0%)                                                                                           |
| Confidence              | High for opening/recency counts; medium for style, strengths and weaknesses without a fresh engine pass. |

## 1. Style, Strengths And Weaknesses

Style read: dynamic, calculation-ready and comfortable in open or semi-open structures. The most important practical clue is not a single opening name, but the repeatability of his early structures shown below.

| Main strengths                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Main weaknesses                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| large public sample with repeated tournament structures, so his main habits are visible; clear White comfort zone around Open/anti Sicilian with 1.e4, Ruy Lopez as White; clear Black comfort zone around Sicilian ...Nc6 systems, KID / ...d6 fianchetto; recent activity in the sample, so old repertoire notes should not be used alone | predictable first-move families as White if you prepare the exact move order; repeated Black structures that let you choose a targeted anti-system rather than broad prep; some repertoire clustering: he can be made to solve a prepared branch rather than choose freely |

## 2. His White Repertoire

| Family                       | Games | Score           | Most common exact setup                              |
|------------------------------|-------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Open/anti Sicilian with 1.e4 | 25    | 12.5/25 (50.0%) | 1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6  |
| Ruy Lopez as White           | 9     | 7/9 (77.8%)     | 1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. d3 Bc5   |
| French as White              | 9     | 4.5/9 (50.0%)   | 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Bd7      |
| Pirc/Modern as White         | 6     | 3.5/6 (58.3%)   | 1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nbd7 4. Bc4 e5 5. a4 Be7   |
| Rossolimo/Moscow vs Sicilian | 4     | 3/4 (75.0%)     | 1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. Bb5 Bd7 4. Bxd7 Qxd7 5. c4 Nf6 |
| Caro-Kann as White           | 4     | 2/4 (50.0%)     | 1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. c4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e6   |
| Reti/KIA fianchetto          | 4     | 1/4 (25.0%)     | 1. Nf3 Nf6 2. g3 g6 3. Bg2 Bg7 4. O-O O-O 5. d3 d5   |
| 1.e4 vs Nc6                  | 2     | 0/2 (0.0%)      | 1. e4 Nc6 2. Nf3 g6 3. d4 Bg7 4. Be3 d6 5. Qd2 Nf6   |

### Most repeated White setup fragments

- 1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 (6 games)
- 1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. c4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e6 (3 games)
- 1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. d3 Bc5 (2 games)
- 1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. d3 d6 (2 games)
- 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Bd7 (2 games)

## 3. His Black Repertoire

| Family                               | Games | Score           | Most common exact setup                              |
|--------------------------------------|-------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Sicilian ...Nc6 systems              | 25    | 14.5/25 (58.0%) | 1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e5 |
| KID / ...d6 fianchetto               | 14    | 11/14 (78.6%)   | 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 g6 4. e4 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O    |
| KID/fianchetto vs flank              | 8     | 5/8 (62.5%)     | 1. c4 Nf6 2. g3 g6 3. Bg2 Bg7 4. Nc3 O-O 5. e4 d6    |
| Sicilian ...d6 systems               | 7     | 3/7 (42.9%)     | 1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 d6 4. d4 cxd4 5. Qxd4 Bd7 |
| Nimzo/QID/Bogo family                | 5     | 3/5 (60.0%)     | 1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 e6 3. c4 b6 4. Nc3 Bb7 5. Bg5 Be7   |
| Symmetrical English / ...c5 vs flank | 3     | 1/3 (33.3%)     | 1. Nf3 Nf6 2. d4 e6 3. c4 b6 4. a3 Bb7 5. Nc3 Be7    |
| Black vs 1.d4 Nf6                    | 3     | 1/3 (33.3%)     | 1. d4 Nf6 2. Nc3 c5 3. dxc5 Qa5 4. Bd2 Qxc5 5. e4 a6 |
| Sicilian Defence                     | 2     | 0/2 (0.0%)      | 1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 Nf6 5. Nf3 Bg4  |

### Most repeated Black setup fragments

- 1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e5 (17 games)
- 1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. c3 d5 4. exd5 Qxd5 5. d4 Bg4 (3 games)
- 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 g6 4. e4 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O (3 games)
- 1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 d6 4. d4 cxd4 5. Qxd4 Bd7 (2 games)
- 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 g6 4. e4 Bg7 5. f3 O-O (2 games)

**Fianchetto shell note: in 26 d4/flank games where he used ...Nf6/...g6/...Bg7, the split is ...d6/KID-ish: 25, ...d5/Gruenfeld-ish: 1. Use the early d-pawn choice as the cue: ...d6 means KID/Benoni thinking, ...d5 means Catalan/Gruenfeld-style central pressure.**

## 4. Recent Form And Recent Openings

Recent form snapshot: last 10 dated games score 8.5/10 (85.0%); since 2025 score 8.5/10 (85.0%). The table below separates current move orders from older historical preferences.

| Date       | Side  | Opponent              | Result  | Setup                                                                  |
|------------|-------|-----------------------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026.02.28 | Black | Akeya-Price, Robert   | 0-1     | KID / ...d6 fianchetto: 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 g6 4. e4 Bg7         |
| 2026.02.28 | Black | Akeya-Price, Robert A | 0-1     | KID / ...d6 fianchetto: 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 g6 4. e4 Bg7         |
| 2026.02.28 | Black | Jackson, Edward       | 1-0     | Sicilian Defence: 1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 Nf6             |
| 2026.02.28 | White | Iyengar, Ilya         | 1-0     | Rossolimo/Moscow vs Sicilian: 1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Nd4 4. Nf3 g6 |
| 2026.02.01 | Black | Hayward, Philip       | 0-1     | KID/fianchetto vs flank: 1. c4 Nf6 2. g3 g6 3. Bg2 Bg7 4. Nc3 O-O      |
| 2026.02.01 | Black | Hayward, Philip T     | 0-1     | KID/fianchetto vs flank: 1. c4 Nf6 2. g3 g6 3. Bg2 Bg7 4. Nc3 O-O      |
| 2026.01.31 | White | Hobson, Kenneth       | 1/2-1/2 | Ruy Lopez as White: 1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6           |
| 2025.11.08 | Black | Bansal, Saahil        | 0-1     | KID / ...d6 fianchetto: 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 g6 4. e4 Bg7         |

## 5. Game Plan For Lachlan

### If You Are Black

Against 1.e4, choose your most familiar defence over novelty-hunting. He has enough open-game/Sicilian experience that a half-known sharp line is the real danger.

### If You Are White

If you play 1.e4, expect Sicilian structures. Either prepare your main anti-Sicilian branch deeply or steer toward your Catalan/Reti comfort instead of giving him his best practical arena.

Against ...Nf6/...g6/...Bg7, stay in Catalan/Reti mode: c4, g3, Bg2, d4, keep central tension, and decide early whether dxe5/dxc5 clarifies in your favour.

### Practical Match Plan

Do not chase tactics unless the forcing line is fully calculated; make compensation prove itself.

Trade into better structure when he accepts isolated pawns, backward pawns, or a weak colour complex.

Prepare one forcing branch against the top repeated setup, then spend the rest of prep on plans and pawn breaks rather than memorising sidelines.

## 6. Before-The-Round Checklist

If considering 1.e4, review your anti-Sicilian choice or choose Catalan/Reti to avoid his repeated Black family.

Review White rep / Reti and Catalan files against ...Nf6/...g6/...Bg7; decide dxc5/dxe5 trigger points.

Bring one practical target to the board: a pawn break, a trade into better structure, or a line that removes his favourite attacking plan.

## 7. Appendix: Representative Setups

| Side      | Setup family                 | Representative line                                               | Read over the board                                                       |
|-----------|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| His White | Open/anti Sicilian with 1.e4 | 1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6     | Use a familiar defence; he is comfortable in open/semi-open play.         |
| His White | Ruy Lopez as White           | 1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. d3 Bc5 6. c3 b5       | Prepare the pawn break and piece placement, not just the first two moves. |
| His White | French as White              | 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Bd7 6. dxc5 Bxc5      | Prepare the pawn break and piece placement, not just the first two moves. |
| His White | Pirc/Modern as White         | 1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nbd7 4. Bc4 e5 5. a4 Be7 6. Nf3 O-O     | Prepare the pawn break and piece placement, not just the first two moves. |
| His White | Rossolimo/Moscow vs Sicilian | 1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. Bb5 Bd7 4. Bxd7 Qxd7 5. c4 Nf6 6. Nc3 Nc6   | Use a familiar defence; he is comfortable in open/semi-open play.         |
| His Black | Sicilian ...Nc6 systems      | 1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. c3 d3 5. c4 d6 6. Bxd3 g6       | Enter only with prep; otherwise use a quieter first-move strategy.        |
| His Black | KID / ...d6 fianchetto       | 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c5 4. d5 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6       | Catalan/Reti pressure; keep central tension and watch ...c5/...e5 timing. |
| His Black | KID/fianchetto vs flank      | 1. c4 e5 2. g3 Nc6 3. Bg2 g6 4. Nc3 Bg7 5. d3 Nf6 6. Nf3 O-O      | Catalan/Reti pressure; keep central tension and watch ...c5/...e5 timing. |
| His Black | Sicilian ...d6 systems       | 1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 d6 4. d4 cxd4 5. Qxd4 Bd7 6. Bxc6 Bxc6 | Enter only with prep; otherwise use a quieter first-move strategy.        |
| His Black | Nimzo/QID/Bogo family        | 1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 e6 3. c4 b6 4. Nc3 Bb7 5. Bg5 Be7 6. e3 h6       | Positional pressure, light-square questions, and patient c-file play.     |

## 8. Sources And Limits

Local En Croissant prep folder PGNs, with one-game files and .info sidecars from local Mega, Chess-Results and Lichess broadcasts where available.

Raw source files: 174; deduped games used in this report: 144.

No fresh engine pass was run. Tactical, positional, strength and weakness conclusions are scouting inferences from openings, results, structures and representative games.